

AI Action Plan
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Re: Knightscope Response to White House AI Action Plan

Bottom Line Up Front (BLUF): Robot Recommendations for the AI Action Plan

The United States of America must lead the world in AI-powered robotics and demonstrate its leadership by rapidly integrating robots into the federal workforce to improve efficiency and effectiveness of core governmental functions. Specifically, the AI Action Plan should make clear that it is the policy of the United States to improve governmental services and citizen protection with AI-powered robotics, including in physical security, where it is immediately feasible to accelerate the future by leveraging the technology already used in the private sector. This can be done now by integrating autonomous security robots (ASRs) into federal facilities, critical infrastructure, and public safety operations.

Key Recommendations for the AI Action Plan

The U.S. should accelerate AI-powered robotic security innovation by implementing the following policies:

1. **Reduce Federal Security Costs:** Show how America will save money with robots. Direct federal agencies to achieve at least a 10% reduction in physical security costs via U.S.-made security robots saving up to \$10 billion a year with this technology while creating new American manufacturing jobs.
2. **Modernize Federal Security Infrastructure:** Integrate advanced robotics into the federal workforce. Outline a near-term pathway to allow for acceleration of robotics across the federal government to improve safety and security.
3. **Deploy a National Pilot for ASRs in Critical Federal Operations:** Direct DHS, DoD, GSA and VA to implement a multi-agency initiative deploying ASRs in high-risk environments such as military bases, airports, and federal buildings.
4. **Ensure Robotics Supply Chain Security:** Prohibit federal procurement of ASRs or related security robotics from adversary nations to mitigate cybersecurity and robot supply chain vulnerabilities mirroring actions taken with aerial drones.

Overview

The United States stands at a crossroads in public safety, law enforcement and security technology. While autonomous systems have already transformed industries globally, the federal government continues to depend on high-cost, labor-intensive methods for security. Meanwhile, criminal networks and adversaries are increasingly deploying AI and autonomous tools that outpace traditional defenses.

The Problem: Federal Security is Costly, Outdated, and Vulnerable

As technologists assess how to best leverage advanced robotics to solve problems within the federal government, physical security stands out as a top category for intervention. Current federal security relies on an expensive, inefficient model that struggles against rapidly evolving threats. Specifically:

- **High Cost:** The federal government spends up to an estimated \$20 billion annually on security guards across DHS, DoD, VA, GSA, and other agencies.
- **Turnover and Staffing Gaps:** Security personnel can face turnover rates as high as 100% - 400% per year, creating inconsistent staffing, risks and training inefficiencies.
- **Modern Threats:** Criminal and hostile actors use AI-driven tactics – autonomous drones and cyber-physical attacks – to bypass traditional security measures.
- **Procurement Roadblocks:** Federal rules fail to incentivize or prioritize the adoption of autonomous solutions, slowing modernization and do not follow basic technology development and deployment principles.

The Solution: Autonomous Security Robots (ASRs) as Force Multipliers

ASRs are already being deployed across corporate campuses, hospital, and industrial settings – showing the future of how robots can team with humans to improve quality of life. They enhance existing security operations, shorten response times, and deliver continuous monitoring free from human limitations at a fraction of the cost of legacy security solutions.

- **Autonomous Threat Detection:** Real-time monitoring, anomaly detection, and automated alerts around facilities of interest.
- **Round-the-clock Coverage:** Robots remain on duty with no breaks, fatigue, and reliability in high-stress environments.
- **85% Cost Savings:** While human security averages \$65 per hour, ASRs operate for about \$11 per hour.
- **Force Multiplication:** When combined with human oversight, ASRs significantly increase both reach and efficiency, keeping security officers safe.
- **Counter-AI Capabilities:** As criminals use AI for illicit activities, ASRs provide a strong defensive layer against sophisticated threats.

Robot Recommendations for the AI Action Plan

Few federal agencies have made use of this technology despite nationwide usage in the private sector, but it is not an area where we can afford to fall behind. Literally. It is estimated that the federal government could save up to \$10 billion annually in physical security costs through the deployment of robots that are now commercially available. Meanwhile, foreign adversaries are already developing advanced robotics and deploying those technologies to advance their national interest. The United States should strive to visibly remain at the forefront of this space by finding near-term, practical ways to incorporate our nation's robotics innovations, especially for security and safety.

The AI Action Plan should accelerate the robot future by:

1. Modernizing Federal Procurement to Prioritize Autonomous Security

- Calling for AI and autonomous robotics to be included in federal security contracts (e.g. DHS, DoD, GSA, VA).
- Directing the creation of performance-based security standards that reward automation and robotics.
- Requiring agencies to explore cost-saving options that incorporate ASRs and other advanced robotics into current infrastructure.
- Mandating a minimum 10% reduction in physical security costs through U.S.-manufactured ASRs and related technologies.

2. Authorizing Autonomous Security in Federally Managed Spaces

- Directing the revision of federal regulations to allow ASRs across military bases, DHS facilities, infrastructure sites, and other relevant installations.
- Expanding counter-drone and anti-intrusion policies to account for robotic security patrols and the prospect of enhanced security from such systems.
- Granting DHS, DoD, GSA, VA and other agencies, as appropriate, the explicit authority to deploy ASRs, cutting red tape and regulatory delays.

3. Establishing a National Autonomous Security Pilot Program

- Instructing DHS, DoD, GSA, and VA to jointly pilot autonomous security solutions in rapid fashion to demonstrate U.S. robotics leadership and increase security of U.S. facilities.
- Focusing large-scale deployments on key U.S. ports, airports, military installations, and other locations where technology scale offers high-cost savings and security enhancements.
- Funding dedicated research within relevant agencies to advance applied robotics for the purposes of improving governmental services and operations.

4. Prohibiting Federal Procurement of Adversary Technologies

- Prohibiting the purchase of autonomous security robots, surveillance systems, and AI-driven security tools from adversary nations due to national security risks – similar to existing standards for aerial drone technology.
- Establishing a federal supply chain security standard requiring that AI-powered security robotics used in federal operations be U.S. manufactured to prevent data exploitation, intellectual property protection, cyber vulnerabilities, and foreign surveillance threats.

Agency-Specific Applications of Autonomous Security Robots (ASRs)

To fully leverage AI-powered robotics for enhanced security and cost savings, the AI Action Plan should include department- and agency-specific adoption strategies. The following table outlines concrete use cases for ASRs across major federal agencies:

FEDERAL AGENCY ASR IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

Agency / Department	Primary Use Case(s) for ASRs	Strategic Benefits
Department of Defense (DoD)	Perimeter security at military bases, munitions depots, airfields, and naval ports.	• Hardens military installations from intrusions, sabotage, and espionage. • Reduces need for human patrols in high-risk areas. • Enhances force protection and real-time threat monitoring.
Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Security at Customs & Border Protection (CBP) facilities, FEMA warehouses, and infrastructure.	• CBP: ASRs at ports of entry and border crossings to enhance threat detection. • FEMA: Secure disaster response supply warehouses from looting or tampering. • DHS HQ: ASRs for facility security at headquarters and training centers.
Transportation Security Administration (TSA)	Extending security reach in airports, cargo facilities, and mass transit hubs.	• Provides continuous surveillance of airport perimeters. • Automates baggage and cargo security monitoring.

Agency / Department	Primary Use Case(s) for ASRs	Strategic Benefits
		• Supports TSA screening officers by detecting anomalies in public transit hubs.
Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI)	Facility security and counter-surveillance for FBI field offices.	• Enhances physical security at FBI offices handling classified investigations. • Supports counter-intelligence operations with automated anomaly detection.
United States Postal Service (USPS)	Logistics hub security and mail theft prevention.	• Similar to private logistics companies (UPS, FedEx, Amazon), ASRs patrol sorting facilities and truck yards. • Reduces risk of mail and package theft at high-volume locations.
National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)	Perimeter defense of high-security research facilities and space launch sites.	• Enhances security at Kennedy Space Center, Johnson Space Center, and other NASA sites. • Monitors entry/exit points at critical research labs.
General Services Administration (GSA)	Security automation for federal office buildings.	• Provides perimeter security for federal buildings and leased office spaces. • Supports facility management teams with real-time incident detection.
Department of Energy (DOE)	Security of nuclear facilities, energy plants, and research labs.	• Automates surveillance of high-security energy infrastructure. • Protects nuclear power plants, laboratories, and DOE research sites.
Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)	Securing VA medical centers, clinics, and housing facilities.	• Monitors VA hospitals and medical campuses to enhance patient and staff safety. • Deters unauthorized entry in veteran housing facilities.
Department of Agriculture (USDA)	Food security and facility protection at USDA	• Protects food supply chain integrity at USDA food storage warehouses.

Agency / Department	Primary Use Case(s) for ASRs	Strategic Benefits
	research labs and storage sites.	Enhances security at agricultural research centers.
Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)	Protection of high-risk environmental monitoring stations and hazardous sites.	- Prevents unauthorized access to toxic waste storage facilities and research labs. - Provides security for water treatment and air quality monitoring sites.
Department of the Interior (DOI)	Wildlife protection, park security, and monitoring of remote federal lands.	- Supports law enforcement rangers in national parks. - Deters illegal activities (poaching, vandalism, and trespassing) on federal lands.
Department of Commerce (DOC)	Security at NOAA, NIST, and critical economic research facilities.	- NOAA: ASRs secure weather monitoring and climate research stations. - NIST: Protects high-value research and cybersecurity testing labs.
Social Security Administration (SSA)	Physical security at SSA offices and records storage sites.	- Provides continuous security for SSA offices where sensitive personal records are stored. - Deters identity fraud and physical breaches at federal records facilities.
Department of Justice (DOJ)	Courthouse security and corrections facility automation.	- Enhances perimeter security of federal courthouses. - Assists in monitoring federal detention centers and correctional facilities.
Department of Health and Human Services (HHS)	Securing CDC, NIH, and major healthcare research institutions.	- CDC: ASRs protect biosafety labs and vaccine storage sites. - NIH: Enhances security at federal biomedical research campuses.
Federal Aviation Administration (FAA)	Security monitoring of critical air traffic control centers.	- Provides intrusion detection for restricted FAA control centers. - Assists in securing sensitive aviation facilities from cyber-physical threats.

Why This Matters: Immediate Impact on National Security & Efficiency

The federal government operates thousands of high-risk, high-value facilities that require continuous security monitoring. ASRs provide:

- Continuous 24/7 monitoring with no fatigue
- Advanced AI-driven threat detection
- Reduced security costs compared to human personnel
- Integration with federal security operations centers

Implementation Roadmap for Federal Adoption

1. **Immediate Pilot Programs:** Launch ASR nationwide trials at VA, TSA, FEMA, DoD, and USPS facilities.
2. **Regulatory Adjustments:** Direct DHS, GSA, and OMB to revise procurement rules to prioritize autonomous security technologies.
3. **Secure Funding:** Leverage existing federal security budgets to fund ASR adoption without increasing overall spending.
4. **Scale Nationwide:** Expand ASR deployment across all major agencies within 3 years.

By rapidly deploying ASRs, the U.S. will achieve major security and cost-efficiency gains while ensuring the federal government remains at the forefront of AI security innovation – while creating new American manufacturing jobs. This AI Action Plan must prioritize immediate adoption of autonomous security solutions to ensure federal agencies operate more securely, efficiently, and intelligently in the age of AI-driven threats.

Conclusion: Cementing U.S. Leadership in AI Robotic Security

It is in the national security interests of the United States of America to move beyond theoretical AI discussions and take concrete steps to integrate AI-driven security solutions. The AI Action Plan should prioritize the deployment of ASRs to:

- Enhance national security by hardening federal infrastructure nationwide
- Reduce federal spending saving taxpayers billions
- Establish U.S. leadership in AI-driven robots

A decisive commitment to AI-powered robotics will ensure that America stays ahead of emerging security threats while optimizing government operations.

Make America the Safest Country in the World.

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